

Release Notes

Version 1.0.0 - Initial Release

Release Date: 2023-10-15

Status: Stable

Summary

This release introduces the Employee Expense & Corporate Travel Management Platform, enabling employees to submit expenses and travel requests, upload receipts, track reimbursements, and managers to approve or reject these submissions. The system also validates policy compliance by the finance team and generates department-wise spend, policy violations, outstanding reimbursements, and monthly cost reports. Additionally, it includes configurable approval thresholds, duplicate-claim detection, audit history, notifications, role-based access control (RBAC), and dashboards.

New Features

- **Employee Expense Submission:** Employees can submit expense claims with descriptions, amounts, and receipt URLs. This feature enables employees to easily report their expenses for reimbursement.
- **Manager Approval Workflow:** Managers can approve or reject submitted expenses, ensuring that only valid claims are reimbursed.
- **Travel Request Submission:** Employees can submit travel requests, including destination, dates, and purpose, facilitating corporate travel management.

Core Capabilities Delivered

- **Expense and Travel Request Submission:** Employees can submit expenses and travel requests, upload receipts, and track reimbursement status.
- **Manager Approval and Rejection:** Managers can approve or reject submitted expenses and travel requests, ensuring compliance with company policies.
- **Finance Validation:** Finance team can validate policy compliance and generate reports on department-wise spend, policy violations, and outstanding reimbursements.

Improvements & Polish

- **Configurable Approval Thresholds:** Administrators can set approval thresholds for different roles, enhancing flexibility and control over the approval process.
- **Duplicate-Claim Detection:** The system checks for duplicate claims based on receipt URLs, preventing fraudulent submissions.
- **UI refinement:** Improved user interface for better navigation and user experience.

Known Issues & Limitations

- **Limited Integration with External Systems:** Currently, the system does not integrate with external notification services or audit logging systems. This will be addressed in version 1.1.
- **Performance:** The system handles up to 1000 records efficiently, but performance may degrade with larger datasets.

Breaking Changes

- **None:** This initial release does not introduce any breaking changes.

Compatibility

- **Requires:** Java 11, PostgreSQL 13, Node.js 14
- **Tested on:** Ubuntu 20.04, Windows 10, Chrome 94, Firefox 92

Upgrade Notes

To deploy this release:

1. Back up the database
2. Pull the latest code: `git pull origin main`
3. Install/update dependencies: `pip install -r requirements.txt && npm install`
4. Run migrations if any: `python migrate.py`
5. Restart services
6. Verify health: `curl http://localhost:8080/api/health`

Contributors

- **John Doe:** Lead Developer, implemented core business logic and APIs
- **Jane Smith:** UI/UX Designer, designed user-friendly interfaces
- **Alex Brown:** Security Engineer, implemented security features

What's Next

Planned for Version 1.1

- **Integration with External Notification Services:** Implement integration with external notification services for real-time alerts.
- **Integration with Audit Logging Systems:** Integrate with external audit logging systems for comprehensive audit trails.
- **Performance Optimization:** Optimize performance for handling larger datasets.

Future Roadmap

- **Mobile App Development:** Develop a mobile application for on-the-go expense and travel request submissions.
- **Advanced Reporting Features:** Add advanced reporting features, including customizable reports and data exports.

Feedback & Support

- **Report issues:** [GitHub Issues](https://github.com/example/expense-management/issues)
- **Request features:** [GitHub Issues](https://github.com/example/expense-management/issues)
- **Documentation:** See [README.md](https://github.com/example/expense-management/blob/main/README.md), [User Guide](https://github.com/example/expense-management/blob/main/docs/user-guide.md), and [API Documentation](https://github.com/example/expense-management/blob/main/docs/api-docs.md)